

Thomas Villalobos Roberts

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EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia Karsh Institute of Democracy - Research Lead | Remote 2023-Present

- Leading research efforts for the UVA Karsh Institute's Democracy and Capitalism Lab, a multi-institution research initiative on the institutional conditions for economic and political development, owning scope, timelines, and deliverables and managing a team of 5+ research assistants
- Developed the theoretical framework and quantitative research approach for the Global Capitalism Index, covering the core dimensions of economic systems across 169 countries and 16 years of data
- Guided data analysis, standardization, and principal components analysis using 300+ datasets across eight subindices
- Authored a 200+ page quantitative research report and peer-reviewed working papers with integrated reviews from senior faculty and prepared findings, memos, and briefings for senior stakeholders and external non-technical audiences
- Tested the index as a forward indicator of emerging market equity risk using multivariate decomposition and backtesting built on derived institutional risk signals

Goldman Sachs - Analyst | New York, NY 2021-2023

- Client Solutions & Capital Markets analyst focused on US institutional insurance client base
- Served as primary point of contact for institutional clients, coordinating across portfolio managers, research analysts, and traders to respond to inquiries and deliver tailored analysis
- Synthesized market, sector, and economic developments into clear, timely briefings for client decision-makers

EDUCATION

University of Virginia - *M.P.P. Accelerated Master of Public Policy* | Charlottesville, VA 2019-2021

Overall GPA: 3.83

Thesis: *Closing the Racial Gap in Retirement Security* in partnership with The Brookings Institution

Relevant Coursework: Advanced Modern Finance, Financial Crises and Civic Reaction, Research Methods & Data Analysis I & II, Advanced Impact Analysis, Economics of Public Policy, Game Theory

Involvements: Graduate Council President, Raven Academic Honor Society

University of Virginia - *B.A. Political Science* | Charlottesville, VA 2016-2020

Major GPA: 3.6

Relevant Coursework: American Political Economy, Comparative Economic Policy, Politics of Developing Areas, Political Economy Independent Thesis, British Economic History, Economics of Social Insurance

Awards: Sky Alland Scholarship Recipient

Involvements: University Historical Tour Guide, Honor Committee Investigator, Seriatim Journal of Politics Managing Editor, Refugee ESL Instructor, Local Economic Development Research Fellow

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: Python, R, Stata, Excel, LaTeX, Tableau

Languages: Portuguese (*Conversational*), Spanish (*Conversational*)

Interests: Independent musician, travel, hiking (*Camino de Santiago*)